

Overcoming Larman's Law

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t.ly/R4jss



Larman's Laws of Organizational Behavior

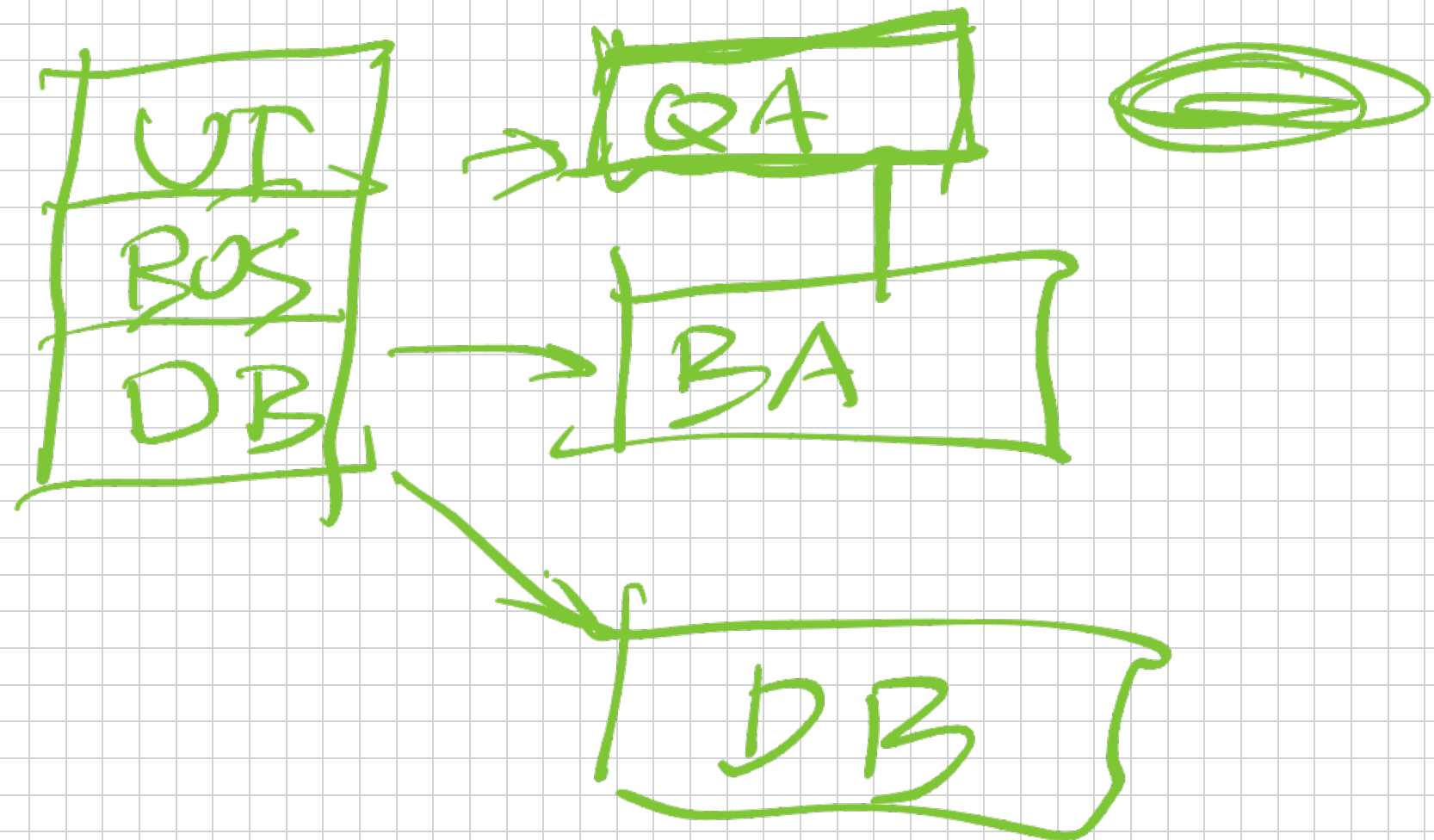
1. Organizations are implicitly optimized to avoid changing the status quo middle- and first-level manager and “specialist” positions & power structures.
2. As a corollary to (1), any change initiative will be reduced to redefining or overloading the new terminology to mean basically the same as status quo.
3. As a corollary to (1), any change initiative will be derided as “purist”, “theoretical”, “revolutionary”, “religion”, and “needing pragmatic customization for local concerns” — which deflects from addressing weaknesses and manager/specialist status quo.
4. As a corollary to (1), if after changing the change some managers and single-specialists are still displaced, they become “coaches/trainers” for the change, frequently reinforcing (2) and (3), and creating the false impression ‘the change has been done’, deluding senior management and future change attempts, after which they become industry consultants.
5. (in large established orgs) Culture follows structure. And in tiny young orgs, structure follows culture.

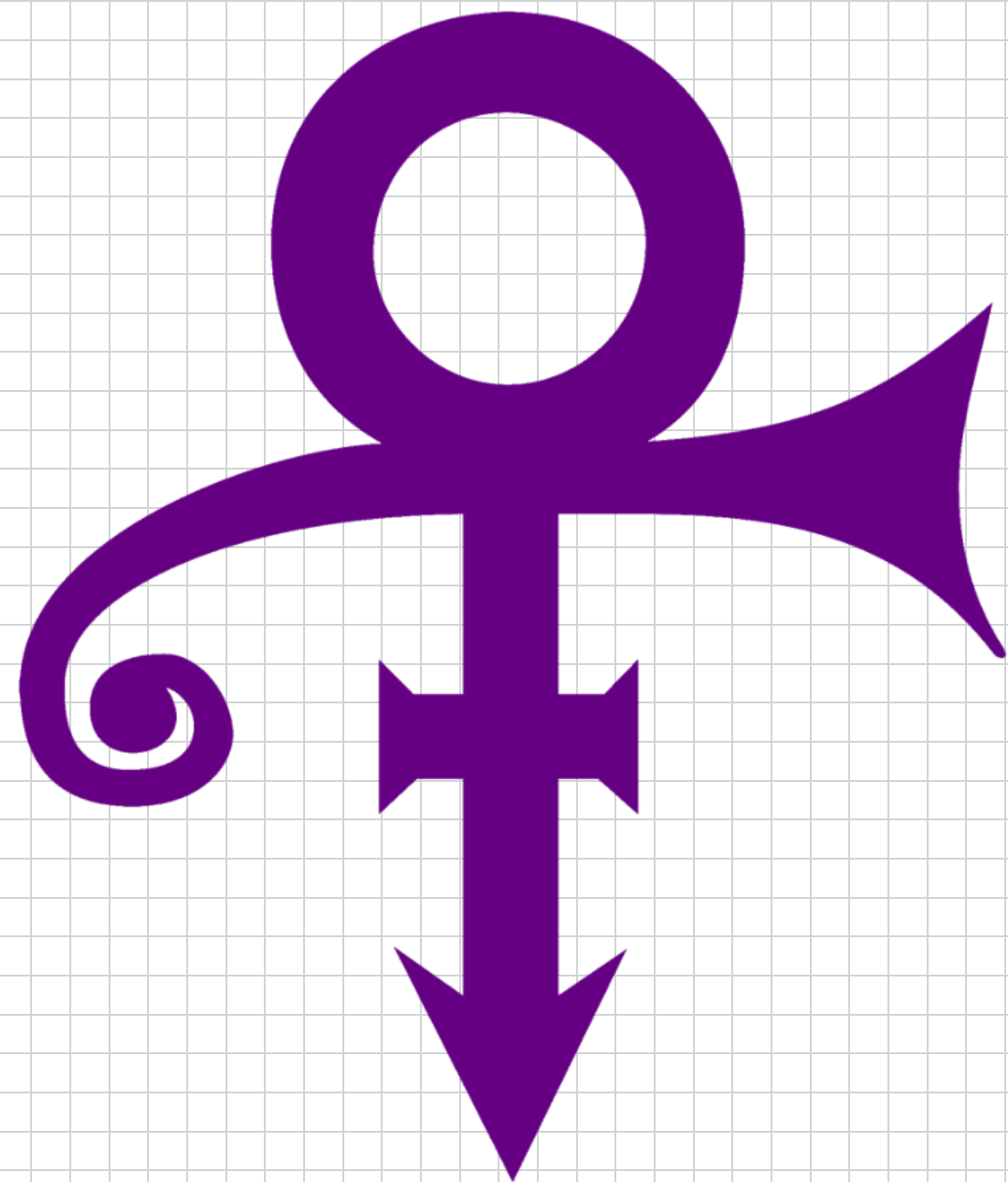


Conway's Law:

[O]rganizations which design systems (in the broad sense used here) are constrained to produce designs which are copies of the communication structures of these organizations.

—Melvin E. Conway, How Do Committees Invent?





Rational Thinking
does not
work.

Software
construction is
a social activity

Communicate
in the language
of the listener

Risk

Money

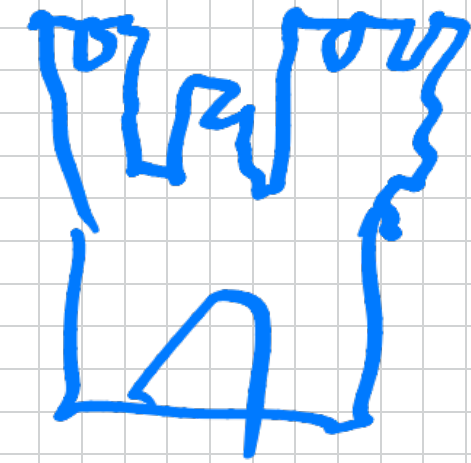
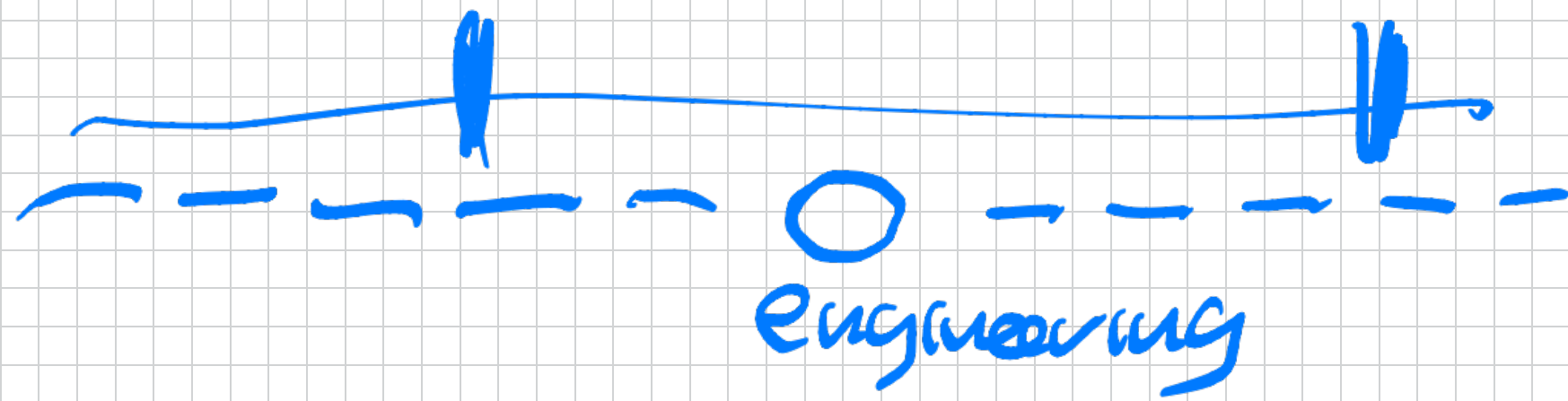
Status

accountability

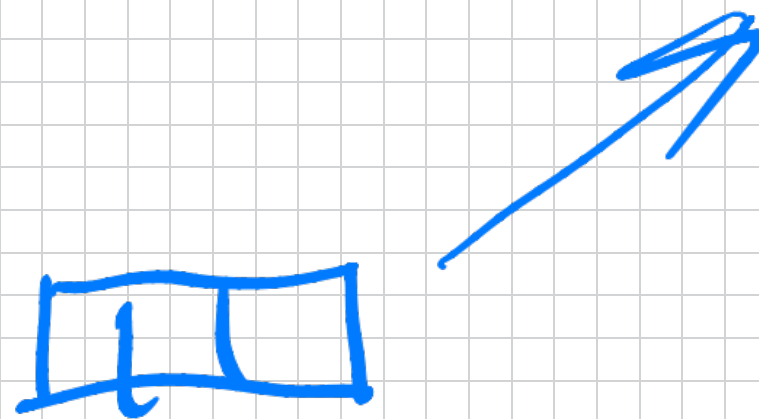
everything is an experiment

Mike Rother "Toyota Kata"

Improvement Kata



What keeps
you up
at night



Current
situation

value stream
mapping

Domain
↓ ↑
Software

Investment

deliver code
sooner

Time value of money
load factor

€100k
€1M

standup
15

integration

x 200 - \$120,000
x 10 \$1.2M
 ~24M-

\$100,000
\$100/hr
600/hr